Test 19:

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

A brief history of ballet

Ballet originated in the Italian Renaissance of the 15th century. The nobility were treated to extravagant events, especially wedding celebrations, where dancing and music created a detailed and fascinating spectacle. Dancing masters taught the dance steps to the nobility, who participated in the performances. In the 16th century Catherine de Medici, an Italian noblewoman, wife of the king of France and a great patron of the arts, began to fund ballet in the French court. Her elaborate festivals encouraged the growth of *ballet de cour*, a programme that included dance, costume, song, music and poetry. A century later, King Louis XIV helped to popularise and standardise the ballet vocabulary. He established the world's first ballet company and danced many roles himself, including that of the Sun King in *Ballet de la Nuit*. His interest in ballet raised it from a hobby for amateurs to a skill requiring professional training.

By 1661, a dance academy had opened in Paris, and in 1681 ballet moved to the stage. The French opera *Le Triomphe de l'Amour* incorporated ballet in its performance, creating a long-standing opera-ballet tradition in France. In the mid-18th century, however, French ballet master Jean Georges Noverre rebelled against the artifice of opera-ballet, believing that ballet could stand on its own as an art form. His ideas – that ballet should contain expressive, dramatic movement, and this should reveal relationships between characters – introduced the *ballet d'action*, a dramatic style of ballet that features a narrative. Noverre's work is considered the forerunner to the narrative ballets of the 19th century.

Early classical ballets such as *Giselle* and *La Sylphide* were created during the Romantic Movement of the first half of the 19th century, which influenced art, music and ballet. The movement was concerned with the world of spirits and magic, and often showed women as passive and fragile. These themes are reflected in the ballets of the time which are called romantic ballets. This is the period in which dancing on the tips of the toes, known as pointe

work, became the normal style for the ballerina. The romantic tutu, a calf-length, full skirt, was also introduced at this time.

By the 19th century the popularity of ballet had soared in Russia and by the end of that century its composers and choreographers – who designed the movements and sets the dancers took – had taken the art form to new levels. *The Nutcracker* and *The Sleeping Beauty*, as choreographed by Marius Petipa, represent classical ballet at its height and form the primary purpose of Russian ballet in this era: to tell a story with technical brilliance. Complicated sequences, high leg lifts and pointe work were created to develop new levels of skill.

In the early part of the 20th century, Russian choreographers Sergei Diaghilev and Michel Fokine began to experiment with movement and costume, moving beyond the traditional limits of classical ballet form and story. Diaghilev collaborated with composer Igor Stravinsky on the ballet *The Rite of Spring*, a work so different – with its revolutionary music, its extraordinary story and its unfamiliar movements – that it caused the audience to riot. Choreographer and New York City Ballet founder George Balanchine, who emigrated to America after dancing in Petrograd (modern-day St Petersburg) and Paris, changed ballet even further. He introduced what is now known as neo-classical ballet, a form that expands beyond the classical form. He is considered by many to be the greatest innovator of the contemporary 'plotless' ballet. With no definite story line, its purpose is to use movement to express the music and to depict human emotions. Today, the ballet takes many forms. Classical approaches, traditional stories and contemporary choreographic innovations blend together to produce the character of modern ballet.

Despite all the changes which ballet has undergone, pointe shoes, which were first worn in the 1930s, have remained the key ballet equipment. Specially made to allow ballerinas to dance on tiptoe, they create an illusion of lightness and even give a sense that the ballerina is floating on air. While they look very delicate, pointe shoes are in fact quite the opposite. The tip of the shoe is a rigid box made of densely packed layers of fabric, cardboard or paper which have been hardened by glue. The box needs to be extremely sturdy since the entire weight of the dancer's body is balanced on it. The rest of the shoe is made of leather, cotton and satin, and each shoe is hand-made to fit a dancer's specifications, which means that you will never see two pairs that are identical. Sometimes, men will also wear pointe shoes, usually for comedic effect, but male dancers usually wear a leather or canvas slipper with a soft sole, which provides flexibility when jumping.

Each time a ballerina gets a new pair of pointe shoes, she has to break them in. This is done by pounding the box of the shoe with a hammer to soften it. Dancers also sew on ribbons or elastic to their shoes to hold their shoes in place. Despite this time-consuming preparation, the shoes may only last for one performance, or even part of a performance, depending on the difficulty of the ballet. In the course of a single season, a professional ballerina can go through 100–120 pairs of pointe shoes.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 1–7 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE — *if the statement agrees with the information*
FALSE — *if the statement contradicts the information*
NOT GIVEN — *if there is no information on this*

1. The first form of ballet was designed as entertainment for Italian society's upper classes.

2. The *Ballet De la Nuit* was Louis XIV's favourite ballet.

3. The strong link between ballet and opera was challenged in mid-18th century France.

4. In the first half of the 19th century the majority of ballet dancers were women.

5. Choreographers in 19th-century Russia were mostly interested in telling a story.

6. The classical tutu was very popular with ballerinas when it was first introduced.

7. George Balanchine began his ballet career in New York.

Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answer in boxes 8–13 on your answer sheet.

Pointe shoes

- first worn in 1930s
- make it seem dancers are **8** _____ rather than dancing
- are **9** _____ in appearance, but this is misleading
- in the tip, layers of fabric, cardboard or paper form a **10** _____
- **11** _____ is used to make the materials tougher
- no two pairs are identical
- a **12** _____ is used to prepare shoes for dancing
- dancers attach ribbons or elastic to their shoes
- ballerina can wear up to **13** _____ pairs in one season

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. TRUE

Trích dẫn:
"Ballet originated in the Italian Renaissance of the 15th century. The nobility were treated to extravagant events, especially wedding celebrations, where dancing and music created a detailed and fascinating spectacle."

Giải thích:
Ballet bắt nguồn từ Ý thời Phục Hưng. Những buổi biểu diễn ban đầu phục vụ cho giới quý tộc trong các sự kiện lớn như lễ cưới.

Đề nói:
"first form of ballet was designed as entertainment for Italian society's upper classes."

- first form = giai đoạn đầu
- upper classes = nobility (quý tộc)

Ý hoàn toàn khớp.

→ **TRUE**

2. NOT GIVEN

Trích dẫn:
"He established the world's first ballet company and danced many roles himself, including that of the Sun King in Ballet de la Nuit."

Giải thích:
Bài chỉ nói Louis XIV:

- thành lập công ty ballet đầu tiên
- từng nhảy vai Sun King trong Ballet de la Nuit

Nhưng đề hỏi:
"Ballet De la Nuit was Louis XIV's favourite ballet."

Từ khóa "favourite" (yêu thích nhất) không xuất hiện.

Không thể suy ra:
ông tham gia vở đó = ông thích nhất.

→ **NOT GIVEN**

3. TRUE

Trích dẫn:
"Jean Georges Noverre rebelled against the artifice of opera-ballet, believing that ballet could stand on its own as an art form."

Giải thích:
Trước đây ballet gắn với opera.

Noverre phản đối sự kết hợp đó và muốn ballet trở thành một loại hình nghệ thuật độc lập.

Đề nói:
"The strong link between ballet and opera was challenged"

= mối liên hệ mạnh giữa ballet và opera bị thách thức.

Đúng.

→ **TRUE**

4. NOT GIVEN

Trích dẫn:
"…often showed women as passive and fragile."

Giải thích:
Bài chỉ nói hình ảnh phụ nữ trong ballet Romantic:

- thụ động
- yếu đuối

Nhưng đề hỏi:
"majority of ballet dancers were women"

= đa số vũ công là nữ.

Bài không nói số lượng nam nữ dancer.

Không thể suy luận từ việc nữ thường xuất hiện trong vai diễn.

→ **NOT GIVEN**

5. TRUE

Trích dẫn:
"The Nutcracker and The Sleeping Beauty… represent classical ballet at its height and form the primary purpose of Russian ballet in this era: to tell a story with technical brilliance."

Giải thích:
Bài nói rõ ballet Nga thế kỷ 19 tập trung vào:

- kể chuyện
- kỹ thuật biểu diễn cao

Đề nói choreographers Nga chủ yếu quan tâm kể chuyện.

Khớp.

→ **TRUE**

6. NOT GIVEN

Trích dẫn:
"The romantic tutu, a calf-length, full skirt, was also introduced at this time."

Giải thích:
Bài chỉ nói:

- tutu được giới thiệu trong thời kỳ Romantic ballet

Không nói:

- nó phổ biến đến mức nào
- ballerina có thích nó không
- nó có được ưa chuộng ngay khi xuất hiện không

Từ "popular" trong đề không có thông tin hỗ trợ.

→ **NOT GIVEN**

7. FALSE

Trích dẫn:
"George Balanchine, who emigrated to America after dancing in Petrograd (modern-day St Petersburg) and Paris…"

Giải thích:
Đề nói:
"George Balanchine began his ballet career in New York."

Nhưng bài cho biết trước khi sang Mỹ ông đã từng nhảy ở:

- Petrograd
- Paris

Vậy ông không bắt đầu sự nghiệp ở New York.

→ **FALSE**

8. floating

Trích dẫn:
"give a sense that the ballerina is floating on air."

Giải thích:
Pointe shoes khiến người xem có cảm giác ballerina đang bay/lơ lửng.

→ **floating**

9. delicate

Trích dẫn:
"While they look very delicate, pointe shoes are in fact quite the opposite."

Giải thích:
Bề ngoài giày trông mỏng manh nhưng thực tế rất cứng.

→ **delicate**

10. box

Trích dẫn:
"The tip of the shoe is a rigid box made of densely packed layers of fabric, cardboard or paper…"

Giải thích:
Phần đầu giày được tạo thành từ một cấu trúc cứng gọi là box.

→ **box**

11. glue

Trích dẫn:
"…which have been hardened by glue."

Giải thích:
Keo làm các lớp vật liệu trở nên cứng hơn.

→ **glue**

12. hammer

Trích dẫn:
"This is done by pounding the box of the shoe with a hammer to soften it."

Giải thích:
Dancer dùng búa để làm mềm phần đầu giày.

→ **hammer**

13. 120

Trích dẫn:
"In the course of a single season, a professional ballerina can go through 100–120 pairs of pointe shoes."

Giải thích:
"up to" = tối đa.

Khoảng cao nhất là 120 đôi.

→ **120**

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14-26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Questions 14 – 20

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A-G**.

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

*Write the correct number, **i-xi**, in boxes 14-20 on your answer sheet.*

List of Headings

i Training coin makers
ii A form of regional promotion
iii More gold than silver in Greece
iv Calculating what a coin was worth
v A simpler, more efficient way of trading
vi Putting a face to famous historical names
vii An uncertain future
viii Careless workmanship caused breakages
ix Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness
x Reading the writing on coins
xi Significant records of past societies

14 Paragraph A
15 Paragraph B
16 Paragraph C
17 Paragraph D
18 Paragraph E
19 Paragraph F
20 Paragraph G

Coins – the first form of money

A

Few people pay much attention to coins; we take them for granted. Since the advent of paper currency and the abandonment of a monetary system based on intrinsic or actual value, they have been demoted to the status of ‘change: what is left when you have paid for something with ‘paper’ money. There is even a belief that they will one day be obsolete, as will paper or plastic notes, and money will at last have achieved the pure status of a mathematical formulation, a system of electronic credits and debits.

B

In the modern media environment, the sheer number of visual images is overwhelming, but it makes one stop to think that coins are among the most durable of our artefacts, and future archaeologists will scrutinise coins in order to learn about their distant ancestors. This is exactly the way ancient coins have informed us for over four millennia. There are thousands of different coins, each designed to carry meaning as well as value, tiny but rich sources of documentary evidence about events and cultural attitudes, frequently produced with exquisite craftsmanship.

C

Coins in Europe date from 2,500 to 2,700 years ago, and seem to have originated in the ancient kingdom of Lydia, in what is now Turkey. Before coins, trade was based on barter: the direct trade of commodities. Barter required the physical presence of both commodities that were being traded. Metal coins were far more portable, and not subject to the same spoilage on long sea journeys as a commodity like grain might be if it became wet. However, they could also be accumulated, and these hoards could be stolen. Coins were therefore a temptation to criminals. The Greeks, however, were the first to realise the full potential of the new invention. They were a trading people of seafarers. Their civilisation, which was composed of dozens of city-states, was highly decentralised. Despite the potential for theft, the Greeks realised that they could benefit enormously from a system that used coins, because it meant that they no longer had to carry goods with them to barter.

D

The value of coins was generally based on the intrinsic value of the metal they were made of. At first this was mostly silver, and this meant that the discovery of silver mines on Greek territory actually increased the quantity of money they could produce. Had the Greek mining been on a larger scale, it could have caused problems similar to those faced by the Spanish centuries later, when so much gold from the New World was brought into their economy that it resulted in serious inflation. One advantage of intrinsic value was that coins could be weighed to determine the amount of metal they contained, so that the only thing an issuing

state had to guarantee was the purity of the metal to prevent accusations of fraud and cheating, which could cause fighting and unrest. This was quite difficult to do, especially with coins made of gold, until Archimedes realised that different metals have different weight-volume ratios, and that by measuring the amount of displacement when coins were immersed in water, it was possible to establish whether gold was alloyed with silver.

E

All ancient coins were made by hand using engraved metal moulds. Many hundreds of coins were made, and as a result the moulds often cracked and new ones had to be engraved. This explains the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs because the moulds had to be remade repeatedly, by many different artisans. One of the distinctive features of coins, in fact, is that they are the work of anonymous craftsmen, and yet each coin is an intimate reflection of the character of its city of origin. It was the Greeks who realised that coins could have a double function, as a unit of value and as a symbol of the identity of the city that issued them. The Greek view of life was deeply motivated by a spirit of competition, and coins, which circulated around the trading world, were a way of advertising the qualities of each particular city-state.

F

Interestingly, Greek coins from the city of Athens, which was the home of the greatest sculptors of the classical period, seem to have been completely disconnected from the high sculptural tradition. The beautiful features of the city's patron, Athena (with her owl on the reverse of the coin), seem to have been repeated virtually unaltered for many years. Perhaps this was because the Athenian currency had grown increasingly to be the international standard and, like the US dollar today, a uniform design implied integrity.

One side of a coin was always occupied by the head of a divinity, so it was a relatively small step, at around 323 BC, for Greek coins to replace that head with the portrait of the reigning monarch, a tradition that has continued in monarchies to the present day. Republics may have either symbolic heads – going back to the older tradition of divinities – or the features of a distinguished past head of state. The Romans adopted the Greek practice of coin design and as a result, the features of many great Romans have survived and are known to modern generations, despite the fact that the art of portrait painting was completely lost for more than a millennium following the fall of the Roman Empire.

*Choose **TWO** letters, **A-E**.*

Write the correct letters in boxes 21 and 22 on your answer sheet.

Which **TWO** of these comments about ancient coins are made by the writer of the text?

A There is no record of the names of the coin makers.
B Coins were not popular as payment for traded objects.
C Coins with the same design often looked quite different.
D Greek coins were more beautiful in design than Roman coins.
E At times, too many coins were produced in Greece.

Questions 23 – 26

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 23-26 on your answer sheet.

Greek traders and coins

The ancient Greek **23** ..... was made up of many city-states which were spread over a large area. Many Greeks were seafarers who travelled the seas trading. Before coins, they had to do this through **24** ..... . This meant that, whenever they set out, they had to carry a lot of goods, which could get damaged on the voyages. The Greeks liked coins; they were made of metal, and the weather and sea had little effect on them. The Greeks had a plentiful supply of **25** ..... which they mined themselves, but were able to avoid the problem of **26** ..... which the Spanish encountered much later, after they allowed too much gold from the New World to enter their economy.

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. Paragraph A: vii (An uncertain future - *Một tương lai bất định: Đề cập đến việc tiền xu có thể trở nên lỗi thời trong hệ thống giao dịch điện tử*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

There is even a belief that they will one day be obsolete, as will paper or plastic notes, and money will at last have achieved the pure status of a mathematical formulation, a system of electronic credits and debits.

15. Paragraph B: xi (Significant records of past societies - *Hồ sơ quan trọng về các xã hội trong quá khứ: Tiền xu là nguồn bằng chứng tài liệu phong phú cho các nhà khảo cổ*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

This is exactly the way ancient coins have informed us for over four millennia. There are thousands of different coins, each designed to carry meaning as well as value, tiny but rich sources of documentary evidence about events and cultural attitudes, frequently produced with exquisite craftsmanship.

16. Paragraph C: v (A simpler, more efficient way of trading - *Cách giao dịch đơn giản và hiệu quả hơn: So sánh ưu điểm của tiền xu so với hệ thống hàng đổi hàng - barter*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Metal coins were far more portable, and not subject to the same spoilage on long sea journeys as a commodity like grain might be if it became wet.

17. Paragraph D: iv (Calculating what a coin was worth - *Tính toán giá trị của đồng xu: Dựa trên giá trị thực của kim loại và cách Archimedes xác định độ tinh khiết*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The value of coins was generally based on the intrinsic value of the metal they were made of.

18. Paragraph E: ii (A form of regional promotion - *Một hình thức quảng bá khu vực: Các thành quốc Hy Lạp dùng tiền xu để quảng bá bản sắc và chất lượng của mình*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The Greek view of life was deeply motivated by a spirit of competition, and coins, which circulated around the trading world, were a way of advertising the qualities of each particular city-state.

19. Paragraph F: ix (Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness - *Đồng xu không thay đổi báo hiệu sự đáng tin cậy: Thiết kế đồng xu Athens được giữ nguyên để khẳng định tính chính trực và tiêu chuẩn quốc tế*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The beautiful features of the city's patron, Athena (with her owl on the reverse of the coin), seem to have been repeated virtually unaltered for many years. Perhaps this was because the Athenian currency had grown increasingly to be the international standard and, like the US dollar today, a uniform design implied integrity.

20. Paragraph G (Phần cuối đoạn F trong PDF): vi (Putting a face to famous historical names - *Đưa khuôn mặt vào các tên tuổi lịch sử nổi tiếng: Việc tạc chân dung các vị vua và người La Mã lên tiền xu giúp thế hệ sau biết mặt họ*).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

One side of a coin was always occupied by the head of a divinity, so it was a relatively small step, at around 323 BC, for Greek coins to replace that head with the portrait of the reigning monarch, a tradition that has continued in monarchies to the present day. Republics may have either symbolic heads – going back to the older tradition of divinities – or the features of a distinguished past head of state. The Romans adopted the Greek practice of coin design and as a result, the features of many great Romans have survived and are known to modern generations, despite

the fact that the art of portrait painting was completely lost for more than a millennium following the fall of the Roman Empire.

Questions 21 – 22:

A: Không có hồ sơ về tên của những người làm tiền xu (Văn bản nêu họ là "anonymous craftsmen" - những thợ thủ công vô danh).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

This explains the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs because the moulds had to be remade repeatedly, by many different artisans. One of the distinctive features of coins, in fact, is that they are the work of anonymous craftsmen, and yet each coin is an intimate reflection of the character of its city of origin.

C: Các đồng xu cùng thiết kế thường trông khá khác nhau (Do khuôn đúc thường xuyên bị nứt và phải chạm khắc lại bởi nhiều nghệ nhân khác nhau).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

This explains the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs because the moulds had to be remade repeatedly, by many different artisans. One of the distinctive features of coins, in fact, is that they are the work of anonymous craftsmen, and yet each coin is an intimate reflection of the character of its city of origin.

Questions 23 – 26:
Greek traders and coins:

23. civilisation: Nền **văn minh** (civilisation) Hy Lạp cổ đại bao gồm nhiều thành quốc.

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Their **civilisation**, which was composed of dozens of city-states, was highly decentralised.

24. barter: Trước khi có tiền xu, họ phải giao dịch thông qua **hàng đổi hàng** (barter).

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Despite the potential for theft, the Greeks realised that they could benefit enormously from a system that used coins, because it meant that they no longer had to carry goods with them to **barter**.

25. silver: Người Hy Lạp có nguồn cung cấp **bạc** (silver) dồi dào từ các mỏ tự khai thác.

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The value of coins was generally based on the intrinsic value of the metal they were made of. At first this was mostly silver, and this meant that the discovery of **silver** mines on Greek territory actually increased the quantity of money they could produce.

26. inflation: Tuy nhiên, họ đã tránh được vấn đề **lạm phát** (inflation) mà người Tây Ban Nha gặp phải sau này khi đưa quá nhiều vàng vào nền kinh tế.

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Had the Greek mining been on a larger scale, it could have caused problems similar to those faced by the Spanish centuries later, when so much gold from the New World was brought into their economy that it resulted in serious **inflation**.

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

What makes a musical expert?

How does someone become expert in music?
And is it really possible to have a talent for music?

Does that class of people acknowledged to be musical experts just have more of the same basic skills we are all endowed with, or do they have a set of abilities — or neural structures — that are totally different from those of the rest of us? Are high levels of musical achievement simply the result of training and practice, or are they based on innate brain structure — what we refer to as talent? Talent can be defined as something that originates in genetic structures and that is identifiable by trained people who can recognize its existence before a person has achieved exceptional levels of performance. The emphasis on early identification means that to investigate it, we study the development of skills in children.

It is evident that some children acquire skills more rapidly than others: the age of onset for walking and talking varies widely, even between children in the same household. There may be genetic factors at work, but these are closely linked with other factors — with a presumably environmental component — such as motivation and family dynamics. Similar factors can influence musical development and can mask the contribution of genetics to musical ability.

Brain studies, so far, haven't been of much use in sorting out the issues. Gottfried Schlaug at Harvard collected brain scans of individuals with absolute pitch* (AP) and showed that a region in the brain called the planum temporale is larger in these people than in others. This suggests that the planum is involved in AP, but it's not clear if it starts out larger in people who eventually acquire AP, or if the acquisition of AP makes the planum increase in size.

Results of research into the areas of the brain involved in skilled motor movement are more conclusive. Studies of violin players have shown that the region of the brain responsible for controlling the movement of the left hand (the hand that requires greater precision in violin playing) increases in size as a result of practice. We do not know yet if the propensity for increase pre-exists in some people and not others.

The evidence against talent comes from research on how much training the experts do. Like experts in mathematics, chess, or sports, experts in music require lengthy periods of instruction and practice. In several studies, the very best music students were found to have practised more than twice as much as the others. In another study, students were secretly divided into two groups based on teachers' perceptions of their talent. Several years later, it was found that the students who achieved the highest performance ratings had practised the most, irrespective of which talent group they had been assigned to, suggesting that practice does not merely correlate with achievement, but causes it.

Anders Ericsson, at Florida State University, approaches the topic of musical expertise as a general problem in cognitive psychology. He takes as a starting point the assumption that there are certain issues involved in becoming an expert at anything; that we can learn about musical expertise by studying expert chess players, athletes, artists, mathematicians, as well as the musicians themselves. The emerging picture from such studies is that ten thousand hours of practice is required to achieve the level of mastery associated with being a world-class expert — in anything. In study after study, of composers, ice-skaters, concert pianists, chess players and master criminals, this number comes up again and again. Someone would do this amount of practice if they practised, for example, roughly 20 hours a week for ten years. Of course, this does not address why some people do not seem to get anywhere when they practise, and why some people get more out of their practice sessions than others. But no-one has yet found a case in which true world-class expertise was accomplished in less time. It seems that it takes the brain this long to assimilate all that it needs to know to achieve true mastery.

The ten-thousand-hour theory is consistent with what we know about how the brain learns. Learning requires the assimilation and consolidation of information in neural tissue. The more experiences we have with something, the stronger the memory/learning trace for that experience becomes. Although people differ in how long it takes them to consolidate information neurally, it remains true that increased practice leads to a greater number of neural traces, which create stronger memory representation.

The classic rebuttal to this theory goes something like this: *What about Mozart? I hear that he composed his first symphony at the age of four!* First, there is a factual error here: Mozart did not write it until he was eight. Still, this is unusual, to say the least. However, this early work received little acclaim and was not performed very often. In fact, the only reason we know about it is because the child who wrote it grew up to become Mozart. And Mozart had an expert teacher in his father, who was renowned as a teacher of musicians all over Europe. We do not know how much Mozart practised, but if he started at age two and

worked thirty-two hours a week (quite possible, given that his father was a stern task-master) he would have made his ten thousand hours by the time he composed his first symphony. This does not mean that there are no genetic factors involved in Mozart's greatness, but that inborn traits may not be the only cause.

Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, ***A, B, C*** *or* ***D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet.

27 In the first paragraph, the writer suggests that a talented musician is someone

A who is aware of being set apart from other people.
B whose brain structure is unlike that of other people.
C who can perform extremely well in early childhood.
D whose essential skills are more varied than those of ordinary people.

28 According to the writer, what is unclear about the findings of Gottfried Schlaug?

A which part of the brain is linked to a particular musical skill.
B which type of musical skill leads to the greatest change in the brain.
C whether a feature of the brain is a cause or an effect of a musical skill.
D whether the acquisition of a musical skill is easier for some people than others.

29 According to the writer, what has been established by studies of violin players?

A Changes may occur in the brain following violin practice.
B Left-handed violinists have a different brain structure from other people.
C A violinist's hand size is not due to practice but to genetic factors.
D Violinists are born with brains that have a particular structure.

30 According to the writer, findings on the amount of practice done by expert musicians suggest that

A talent may have little to do with expertise.
B practice may actually prevent the development of talent.

C talent may not be recognised by teachers.
D expertise may be related to quality of instruction.

Questions 31–36

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 31–36 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO — if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

31 Anders Ericsson's work with cognitive psychology has influenced other researchers.

32 Different areas of expertise seem to have one specific thing in common.

33 In order to be useful, practice must be carried out regularly every day.

34 Anyone who practises for long enough can reach the level of a world-class expert.

35 Occasionally, someone can become an expert at a global level with fewer than 10,000 hours' practice.

36 Existing knowledge of learning and cognitive skills supports the importance of practice.

Questions 37–40

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–J**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–J**, in boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet.*

Mozart

The case of Mozart could be quoted as evidence against the 10,000-hour practice theory. However, the writer points out that the young Mozart received a lot of **37** _____ from his father, and that the symphony he wrote at the age of **38** _____ was not **39** _____ and may be of only academic interest. The case therefore supports the view that expertise is not solely the result of **40** _____ characteristics.

A popular
B artistic
C completed
D eight
E tuition
F encouragement
G inherited
H four
I practice
J two

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. B: Trong đoạn đầu tiên, tác giả gợi ý rằng một nhạc sĩ tài năng là người có **cấu trúc não bộ khác biệt** so với những người khác (Đoạn 1: "...innate brain structure – what we refer to as talent").

28. C: Điểm chưa rõ ràng về phát hiện của Gottfried Schlaug là liệu một đặc điểm của não bộ là **nguyên nhân hay kết quả** của một kỹ năng âm nhạc (Đoạn 3: "...it's not clear if it starts out larger... or if the acquisition of AP makes the planum increase in size").

29. A: Các nghiên cứu về người chơi violin đã xác định được rằng **những thay đổi có thể xảy ra trong não bộ** sau khi luyện tập violin (Đoạn 4: "...region of the brain... increases in size as a result of practice").

30. A: Những phát hiện về lượng thời gian luyện tập của các nhạc sĩ chuyên nghiệp cho thấy **tài năng có thể ít liên quan** đến trình độ chuyên môn (Đoạn 5: nhấn mạnh việc luyện tập là nguyên nhân trực tiếp dẫn đến thành tựu, bất kể xếp loại tài năng ban đầu).

31. NOT GIVEN: Không có thông tin về việc công việc của Anders Ericsson có ảnh hưởng đến các nhà nghiên cứu khác hay không.

32. YES: Các lĩnh vực chuyên môn khác nhau dường như có một điểm chung cụ thể (Đoạn 6: đều cần khoảng 10.000 giờ luyện tập để đạt mức bậc thầy).

33. NOT GIVEN: Bài đọc không khẳng định việc luyện tập phải được thực hiện "đều đặn mỗi ngày" để có hiệu quả (chỉ đưa ra con số trung bình theo tuần).

34. NO: Bất kỳ ai luyện tập đủ lâu cũng có thể đạt đến trình độ chuyên gia thế giới (Đoạn 6: tác giả có nhắc đến việc một số người luyện tập nhưng không đi đến đâu - "some people do not seem to get anywhere").

35. NO: Hiếm khi có ai trở thành chuyên gia cấp toàn cầu với ít hơn 10.000 giờ luyện tập (Đoạn 6: "no-one has yet found a case... in less time").

36. YES: Kiến thức hiện tại về việc học tập và kỹ năng nhận thức ủng hộ tầm quan trọng của việc luyện tập (Đoạn 7: lý thuyết 10.000 giờ nhất quán với cách não bộ học tập).

37. E (tuition): Mozart khi còn nhỏ đã nhận được rất nhiều **sự giảng dạy/huấn luyện** từ cha mình.

38. D (eight): Bản giao hưởng mà ông viết vào năm **8 tuổi** (thay vì 4 tuổi như lời đồn).

39. A (popular): Tác phẩm sớm này **không phổ biến** (ít được hoan nghênh và biểu diễn).

40. G (inherited): Trường hợp này ủng hộ quan điểm rằng chuyên môn không chỉ đơn thuần là kết quả của các đặc điểm **di truyền**.

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